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DESKTOP USER GUIDE

# OverHead Desktop User Guide

A hands-on guide for a local-first Windows office workspace.

**Release 0.3.27 | Updated November 1, 2026**

Practical instructions for setup, daily work, data handling, updates, and recovery.

**Read this first**
Product behavior and available controls vary by edition, Windows compatibility, account role, plan, and connected services. This guide explains current product workflows; it is not legal, accounting, or security advice.

Use the table of contents to find a task. Read the data and security boundaries before moving, exporting, restoring, or sharing records.

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# 1. Choose the right OverHead package

OverHead Desktop is the individual-user office workspace for a regular Windows 10 or Windows 11 workstation. Cylinder Server is for supported Windows Server or Windows IoT hosts. Cylinder Client is for managed Windows 10/11 endpoints connected to a Cylinder workspace. The products share daily office workflows, but use separate installers, data folders, and update feeds.

| Package | Use | Important boundary |
|---|---|---|
| OverHead Desktop | Windows 10/11 workstation | Individual-user workspace; no department Rank/device control plane. |
| Cylinder Server | Supported Server/IoT host | Department host; manages Cylinder membership, departments, Ranks, and devices. |
| Cylinder Client | Managed Windows 10/11 workstation | Employee endpoint; it does not administer the department. |

**Local-first data**
Customer records and attachments remain on the computer where they are stored unless you explicitly use a supported sync or export. Accounts, security, and plan status can use connected services; that does not make local business files automatically synchronize.

The screenshots in this guide are illustrative examples. Product labels, sections, available actions, and access can vary with version, account role, plan, settings, and connected services.

# 2. Install and open your workspace

1. Use the official OverHead download page or an approved organization distribution share. Confirm the product name and version before opening the installer.
2. Run the product installer and follow its Windows prompts. If using a ZIP, extract all files and keep the folder together; do not launch the application from inside the ZIP.
3. Open OverHead from the installed shortcut. Choose the correct Desktop or Cylinder package; never install one product over another.
4. On first use, review the Manager's first-install notices when presented. Choose the explicit Yes, I agree option to proceed. Choosing No, I do not agree cancels the first-install flow.
5. Create a workspace or sign in with the approved work account. Complete email verification if requested.

**Before installation**
The Manager checks Windows compatibility, hardware, available space, package integrity, and publisher status according to the Manager build's policy. An unsigned local Manager can verify release hashes but cannot independently identify the publisher.

## Create a workspace or join the staff workspace

For a new office workspace, choose Create Workspace and enter the requested owner and business details. Use a unique password. For an existing staff identity, select OverHead Team and sign in with the account issued for your workspace. Customer Access is a separate customer support portal; it does not open the staff workspace.

After sign-in, confirm the business name and role on Team Dashboard. If access is limited, review the account's plan and role with the workspace owner instead of creating a duplicate account.

# 3. Sign in, verify email, and recover access

1. Choose the correct sign-in mode: staff workspace, customer support access, or workspace creation.
2. Enter the account email/username first and continue. OverHead checks the account before presenting the password step.
3. Enter the password. Use the sign-in page's Forgot your password link if you cannot remember it, then follow the current email instructions.
4. Open the newest verification or recovery email. Use its link promptly and return to OverHead to finish sign-in.
5. If the link has expired, request a new one. Do not forward password-reset links, verification links, or recovery details to another person.

> **Keep one identity per account**
> A username check is an account lookup, not proof that the person entering it owns the account. Passwords and recovery links remain private. Contact the workspace owner or support if email access has been lost.

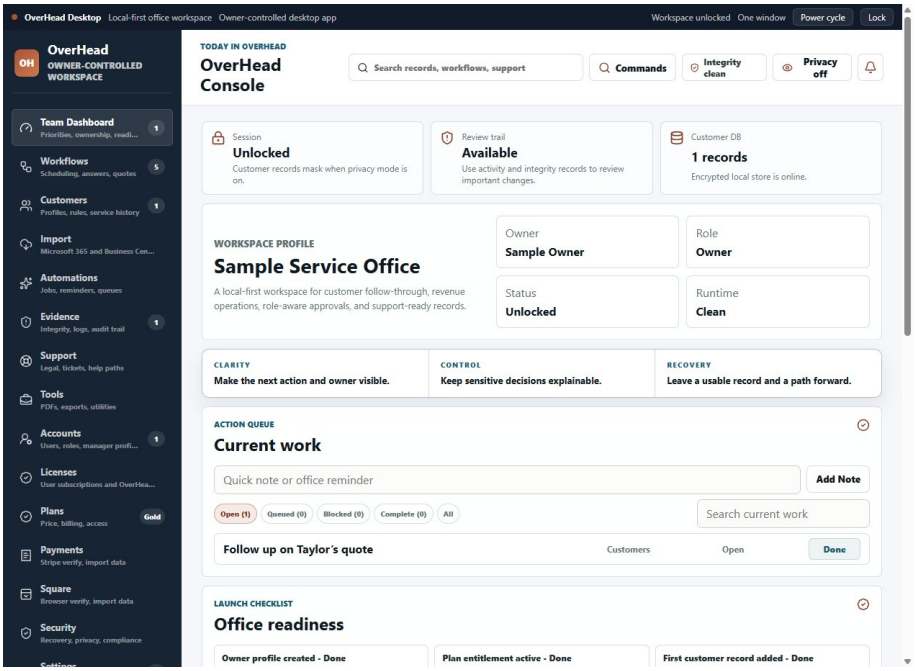
Repeated failures may be caused by a typo, an unverified email, an expired link, stale connectivity, or the wrong account mode. Record the exact message and step that failed; never send your password or recovery token in a support request.

# 4. Navigate and use the dashboard

Use the left navigation to open a workspace. Scroll the main area to reach controls below the first screen. The top search, command palette, action inbox, setup checklist, privacy toggle, lock control, and update control provide common shortcuts.

1. Start on Team Dashboard and review Current work.
2. Use Open, Queued, Blocked, Complete, or All to filter work; clear the search if expected records are missing.
3. Add one specific next action as a note or reminder. Mark a task Done only after completing the real-world work.
4. Use Customize dashboard or the Workspace directory to hide, reorder, or group navigation items. These preferences are local display settings; hiding a section does not change permissions.

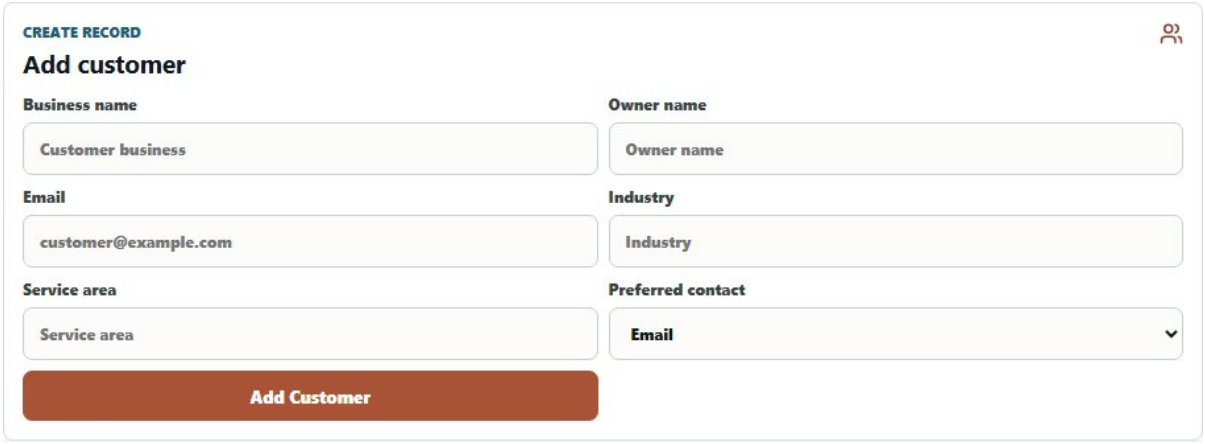
> **Status is a record**
> A Completed quote, invoice, task, or appointment status records what was entered in OverHead. It does not prove that an email was delivered, a customer accepted an offer, or a payment was processed.




*Example: dashboard and current-work overview.*

# 5. Add customers and manage documents

1. Open Customers and find Add customer.
2. Enter the business and contact details requested by the form. Review the email address and preferred contact method.
3. Select Add Customer and wait for confirmation before submitting again.
4. Use search to find the saved customer and confirm the selected name before creating related work.




*Example: customer record fields.*

## Attach and retrieve files

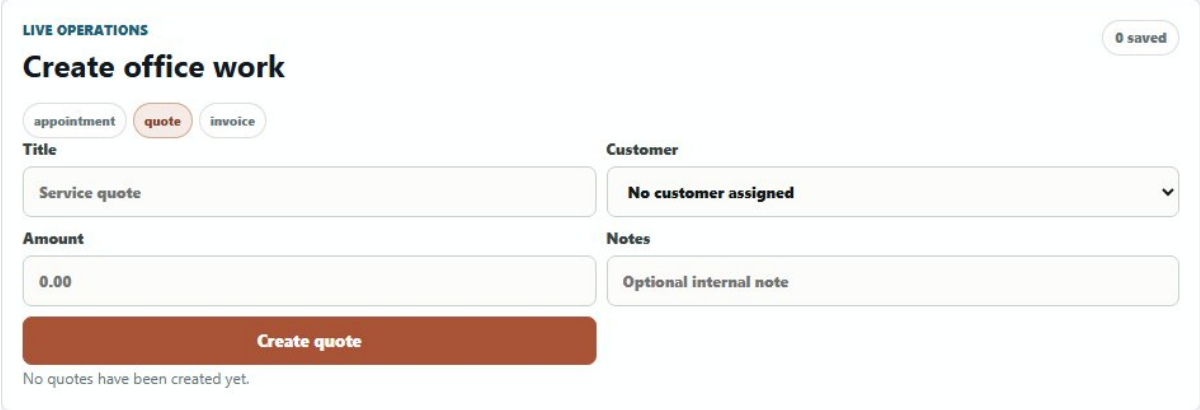
1. Select the intended customer, then choose Attach Document.
2. Choose a file smaller than 25 MB and give it a useful label.
3. Confirm the label appears under the correct customer. Select it to open the file in its associated Windows application.
4. Use document bundles, content search, or PDF annotations only for supported formats and limits. Search does not include image OCR, PDF OCR, or every spreadsheet format.

**Files and sync**
Customer attachments are stored locally with the workspace data. Customer synchronization does not transfer attachment files to another computer. Keep original documents and a separate copy of important files.

# 6. Create appointments, quotes, and invoices

1. On Team Dashboard, open Create office work and choose appointment, quote, or invoice.
2. Enter a clear title and select the correct customer. Add the date, amount, due date, and internal notes required by that record type.
3. Select the create action and wait for a success or error message.
4. Use Update and deliver work to find the saved record, change a supported status, or correct its customer assignment.
5. For a quote or invoice PDF, use the relevant Create PDF action and note the saved file path.

| Record | Example status values | Check separately |
|---|---|---|
| Appointment | Scheduled, Confirmed, Complete, Canceled | Calendar invitation or customer notification delivery. |
| Quote | Draft, Sent, Accepted, Declined | Whether the quote was actually sent and accepted. |
| Invoice | Open, Sent, Paid, Overdue | Whether a payment processor confirmed payment. |




*Example: create-office-work controls.*

# 7. Tasks, workflows, reminders, and reports

Use Workflows and Automations for repeatable local work. A workflow template can create a next action; queued jobs may need an authorized user to process or retry them. Review a failed job before retrying so the same external action is not duplicated.

- Work Planner: review task order, dependencies, estimates, capacity, and shift handoffs. Capacity figures depend on the entries supplied by your team.
- Reports: filter supported records and export local CSV summaries. Review the destination and contents before sharing.

- Growth & Work and Sales Studio: use boards and forecasts as planning aids. Estimates and forecasts are not guaranteed outcomes.
- Scheduling: create local appointments and planning records. Public booking and external calendar synchronization require separately configured services.
- Customer Management: review segments, duplicate alerts, history, and feedback. Review the records and take a backup before a local merge.

> **Queued work may be local**
> A reminder or job scheduled inside OverHead may run only while the application and relevant local services are available. Do not treat it as a guaranteed external email, text, calendar event, or payment unless the connected provider confirms it.

# 8. Accounts, roles, plans, and integrations

An account's sign-in identity, application role, plan entitlement, and local data are related but separate. Ask the workspace owner to review the correct account and access when a section is locked.

| Role | Typical access |
|---|---|
| Owner | Workspace-wide administration and approvals. |
| Front Desk | Customer follow-up and office operations as permitted by the workspace. |
| Bookkeeper | Finance, invoices, expenses, and reporting as permitted. |
| Support | Support workflows and assigned access; not automatic owner authority. |

Microsoft 365 and Square connectors require external account setup and the permissions displayed by the provider. Use the minimum permissions needed. Never place provider secrets, passwords, or payment credentials into notes or customer records. Some integration screens only import or export files and do not imply live synchronization.

Desktop trial and Cylinder evaluation rules differ. Review Plans and Licenses for the entitlement assigned to this workspace. A trial screen is not evidence that a paid plan is active, and a saved test reference does not authorize a charge.

# 9. Privacy, security, and screen controls

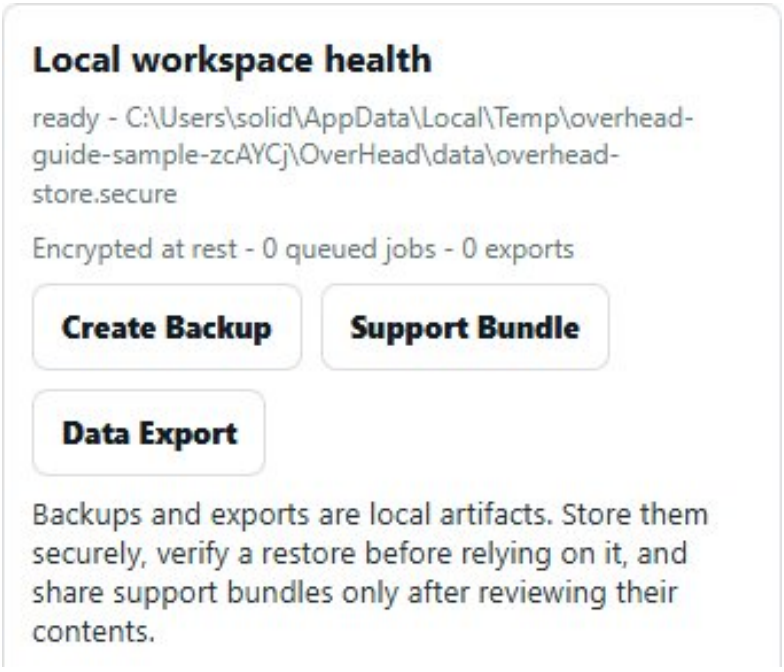
- Privacy on/off masks selected sensitive fields on screen. It does not delete, encrypt a screenshot, or prevent someone from photographing the display.
- Lock the session when leaving the desk. Sign out or close the application when a shared computer will be unattended.
- Use Evidence and Security to review available local integrity, audit, session, privacy, and recovery information. A clean indicator is not a guarantee against every threat.
- Use role-limited accounts and avoid sharing credentials. Keep Windows, endpoint protection, and account recovery methods current.
- Open support bundles and exports yourself before sending them. They may include business or diagnostic information.

**Security boundary**
OverHead controls do not replace Windows account security, network/VPN controls, organizational policies, provider security, or independent backups. A program-level hash can show file differences; it does not prove publisher identity or prevent a determined person with device access from altering an unsigned build.

# 10. Store, export, back up, and restore data

OverHead Desktop stores its local workspace under the current Windows account's OverHead data folder unless the Install Manager has configured a custom Desktop data root. Keep backups under access controls appropriate for customer information.

1. Open Settings and find Local workspace health.
2. Select Create Backup and wait for the verified path.
3. Keep a protected copy on a different device or storage system. Preserve attached documents and generated files separately; a database backup may not include every file.
4. For an export, choose a destination you control and inspect the contents before sharing.
5. Before restoring, create a fresh backup. Choose the intended supported store file, select Validate Restore, and stop if validation fails.
6. Only after confirming the target should you type the requested confirmation and select Restore. Sign in again and check expected records afterward.




*Example: local workspace health and backup controls.*

**Restore replaces local workspace data**
Restore is not a merge. Keep the safety copy and the original documents until you have verified the recovered workspace.

# 11. Updates and troubleshooting

Desktop uses its Manager-led update workflow when packaged with the Manager companion. The app checks its product update source, shows release availability, and asks before starting the Manager update flow. The Manager verifies matching release metadata and installer hash, preserves user data, and checks the resulting installation according to that build's trust policy.

Automatic checks are limited by the saved update schedule. Cylinder Server and Cylinder Client use their separate standalone updater feeds. Never install a Desktop installer over Cylinder or mix the product feeds.

| Problem | First checks |
|---|---|
| Customer-only screen | Return to staff sign-in and choose OverHead Team. |
| No work appears | Confirm workspace, clear search, choose All, and check role/plan access. |
| Password or verification failure | Check the email, use the newest message, and restart the recovery flow if its link expired. |
| File not found | Use the saved path shown by OverHead and check Windows file association. |
| Sync or update failure | Check network access, read the exact error, then retry after connectivity returns. |
| Restore warning | Stop, confirm the source file and workspace, and preserve the current data before proceeding. |

For support, note the product, app version, Windows edition, page/action, exact error text, and the last successful step. Contact the published support address or website. Do not send passwords, recovery codes, payment credentials, or unredacted customer data.

# 12. A practical daily routine

| When | Routine |
|---|---|
| Start of day | Confirm the workspace and role. Review current work, blocked items, appointments, open quotes, and invoices due. |
| After a customer contact | Find or add the customer, create the correct record, write the next step, and attach only the necessary document. |
| Before sending an export | Confirm the recipient, destination, file contents, and whether the file contains customer information. |
| End of day | Confirm saved changes, mark completed work, record the next action, check sync status when used, and lock the session. |
| After important local changes | Create a backup and preserve attachments separately. |

**Keep the workflow small**
Start with one customer, one record, and one next action. Configure optional integrations only when a provider account and an authorized owner are ready.